

Word family: **love / loves / loved / loving / lovely / lovable / beloved / lover**

Base word: love

Past tense: loved

Past participle: loved

Related forms: loving, lovely, lovable, beloved, lover

Useful expressions / extensions: fall in love, be in love, love doing something, love someone, love of something, loved one

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / adjective-related family (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “She is the kind of person who shows **love** through small actions rather than big speeches.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **love** means **deep affection, care, and emotional attachment toward other people**.

In your passage, your grandmother expresses that affection through practical actions such as making tea, cutting fruit, and caring for family members.

So **love** here is not specifically romantic.

繁體中文： **對家人或他人深厚的關愛、感情和在乎，並希望照顧對方、為對方好**

中文翻譯：

> “She is the kind of person who shows love through small actions rather than big speeches.”

「她是那種會透過細微行動來表達**關愛 / 愛意**，而不是靠大篇幅說話的人。」

Here:

show love = 透過行動、言語或照顧表達對某人的深厚關心和感情

1. **love + person (深愛某人) — 愛 ; 深愛**

Meaning: To feel deep affection, care, and emotional attachment toward someone.

Practice 1

> “She **loves** her grandchildren very much.”

「她非常**疼愛 / 深愛**自己的孫兒女。」

Practice 2

> “I **love** my family.”

「我**愛**我的家人。」

love someone = 對某人有深厚感情、關心和情感連繫

2. **love** = deep family/friendship affection (親情 / 友情中的愛) — 關愛；深厚感情

This is the exact broader sense in your passage.

Practice 3 — Original

> “She shows **love** through small actions.”

「她透過細微行動表達**關愛**。」

Practice 4

> “His parents showed their **love** by supporting him during difficult times.”

「他的父母在困難時支持他，以此表達他們的**愛與關懷**。」

Practice 5

> “There was a lot of **love** in their family.”

「他們一家人之間有很多**愛和關懷**。」

love = 家人、朋友或親近的人之間深厚的關心、情感和依附

3. **romantic love** (愛情) — 愛情；戀愛感情

A major distinct branch.

Practice 6

> “They fell in **love** at university.”

「他們在大學時**墮入愛河 / 相愛**。」

Practice 7

> “The film is a story about **love** and loss.”

「這部電影是一個關於**愛情**與失去的故事。」

love = 兩人之間帶有浪漫和親密意味的深厚感情

This is different from the family affection in your passage.

4. **be in love with + person — 愛上某人；正在戀愛**

Practice 8

> “She is **in love with** him.”

「她**愛上了他 / 正在和他相戀**。」

Practice 9

> “He realized that he was still **in love with** her.”

「他意識到自己仍然**愛著她**。」

be in love with someone = 對某人有強烈浪漫愛情

5. **fall in love with + person — 愛上某人**

Practice 10

> “They **fell in love** very quickly.”

「他們很快便**相愛了**。」

Practice 11

> “She **fell in love with** him after they worked together.”

「他們一起工作後，她漸漸**愛上了他**。」

fall in love = 開始對某人產生浪漫愛情

6. **love + activity/thing (非常喜愛) — 很喜歡 ; 熱愛**

A very common non-romantic verb meaning.

Practice 12

> “I **love** travelling.”

「我**很喜歡 / 熱愛**旅行。」

Practice 13

> “She **loves** music.”

「她**非常喜歡**音樂。」

love something/doing something = 非常喜歡某件事或某項活動，享受程度很高

This does not necessarily involve deep emotional attachment in the same way as loving a person.

7. **love to do / love doing — 很喜歡做.....**

Practice 14

> “She **loves to cook** for her family.”

「她**很喜歡為家人煮飯**。」

Practice 15

> “He **loves reading** before bed.”

「他**很喜歡睡前閱讀**。」

love to do / love doing = 非常享受某項活動

Both are common.

8. **would love to + verb — 很想 ; 非常樂意**

A very useful conversational construction.

Practice 16

> “I’d **love to** visit her this weekend.”

「我這個週末**很想去探望她**。」

Practice 17

> “We’d **love to** join you.”

「我們**很樂意 / 很想**加入你們。」

would love to = 非常想做某事，或很樂意接受邀請

This is more polite and enthusiastic than plain:

> want to

9. **love of + noun (對.....的熱愛) — 熱愛；喜愛**

Practice 18

> “Her **love of** music began when she was a child.”

「她對音樂的**熱愛**從小就開始了。」

Practice 19

> “They share a **love of** travel.”

「他們都**熱愛旅行**。」

love of something = 對某個活動、領域或事物持久而強烈的喜愛

10. **for the love of + person/thing (因為愛 / 重視) — 為了.....的愛；出於對.....的重視**

Practice 20

> “She did it for the **love of** her family.”

「她這樣做是**出於對家人的愛**。」

Practice 21

> “He teaches for the **love of** the subject.”

「他教這門學科，是因為他**真正熱愛這個領域**。」

for the love of something/someone = 因為真正喜愛、重視或關心而做某事

11. **love = person who is deeply loved (所愛的人 / 愛人) — 愛人；心愛的人**

A noun referring to a person.

Practice 22

> “She was the great **love** of his life.”

「她是他一生中最重要**愛人 / 摯愛**。」

Practice 23

> “He never forgot his first **love**.”

「他從沒有忘記自己的**初戀**。」

love = 被某人深深愛著的人，尤其常帶浪漫意味

12. **first love — 初戀；最早深愛的事物**

Practice 24

> “She still remembers her **first love**.”

「她仍然記得自己的**初戀**。」

Practice 25

> “Music was his **first love**.”

「音樂是他最早而且最深的**熱愛**。」

****first love = 最早產生深厚感情的人，或最早真正熱愛的活動 / 事物****

This can be romantic or figurative.

13. ****loved one = 親人；摯愛的人****

A very important fixed expression.

Practice 26

> “It is important to spend time with your ****loved ones****.”

「花時間陪伴自己的****親人 / 摯愛的人****很重要。」

Practice 27

> “She wanted to stay close to her ****loved ones****.”

「她希望留在自己的****親人****身邊。」

****loved one = 自己深愛、非常在乎的人，通常指家人或伴侶****

14. ****love = affection shown through actions (關愛行為) — 愛的表現；關愛****

This is especially relevant to your original sentence.

Practice 28

> “Cooking for everyone was her way of showing ****love****.”

「為大家煮飯是她表達****關愛****的方式。」

Practice 29

> “Small acts of kindness can communicate ****love****.”

「細微的善意行為也可以傳達****愛與關懷****。」

****love = 透過照顧、支持、陪伴或實際行動表達的深厚關心****

This is the exact nuance of your grandmother's behaviour.

15. **self-love — 自愛；珍惜自己**

A common modern compound.

Practice 30

> “Healthy **self-love** includes respecting your own needs.”

「健康的**自愛**包括尊重自己的需要。」

Practice 31

> “She learned that **self-love** is different from selfishness.”

「她明白到**自愛**和自私並不相同。」

self-love = 對自己的價值、需要和身心狀態保持尊重和關愛

16. **love = enthusiasm/passion for something (熱情) — 熱愛；熱情**

This overlaps with “love of something” but can describe a person's motivating passion.

Practice 32

> “His **love** for teaching is obvious.”

「他對教學的**熱愛**很明顯。」

Practice 33

> “Her **love** for animals led her to become a vet.”

「她對動物的**熱愛**令她成為獸醫。」

love for something = 對某個領域或對象持久而強烈的熱情

17. **love — tennis score = zero (網球) — 零分**

A genuinely separate lexical meaning.

Practice 34

> “The score is fifteen-**love**.”

「比分是十五比**零**。」

Practice 35

> “She won the game forty-**love**.”

「她以四十比**零**贏下這局。」

love = 網球計分中的零分

This is completely unrelated to affection in modern meaning.

18. **loving** = showing affection and care (充滿愛的) — 有愛心的 ; 關愛的

The main adjective form.

Practice 36

> “She is a very **loving** grandmother.”

「她是一位非常**疼愛**家人的外婆。」

Practice 37

> “The children grew up in a **loving** home.”

「孩子們在一個**充滿關愛**的家庭環境中長大。」

loving = 經常表現出愛、關懷、溫柔和照顧的

This fits your grandmother extremely well.

19. **lovingly** = with love/care (充滿愛意地) — 關愛地 ; 用心地

Practice 38

> “She **lovingly** prepared food for the family.”

「她**充滿愛意地 / 用心地**為家人準備食物。」

Practice 39

> “He spoke **lovingly** about his grandmother.”

「他談起外婆時語氣**充滿愛意**。」

****lovingly = 以表現出愛、溫柔或深厚關懷的方式****

20. ****lovable = easy to love (惹人喜愛的) — 可愛的 ; 令人喜愛的****

Practice 40

> “He can be difficult, but he is still very **lovable**.”

「他有時很難相處，但仍然很**惹人喜愛**。」

Practice 41

> “The character is funny and **lovable**.”

「這個角色既有趣又**討人喜愛**。」

****lovable = 性格或特質令人自然產生喜愛和感情的****

21. ****beloved = dearly loved (深愛的 / 摯愛的) — 深受愛戴的 ; 摯愛的****

A stronger and more literary/formal adjective.

Practice 42

> “She was a **beloved** grandmother.”

「她是一位**深受家人愛戴的外婆**。」

Practice 43

> “The writer returned to his **beloved** hometown.”

「作家回到了自己**深愛的故鄉**。」

****beloved = 被某人或很多人深深愛著、珍惜的****

Can sound literary, affectionate, or formal.

22. ****lover = romantic/sexual partner (愛人 ; 情人) ****

A related person noun.

Practice 44

> “The story follows two young ****lovers****.”

「故事講述一對年輕****戀人****。」

Practice 45

> “They were childhood friends who later became ****lovers****.”

「他們原本是兒時朋友，後來成為了****戀人****。」

****lover = 與某人有浪漫或性關係的人****

This word can sound more intimate than:

> boyfriend / girlfriend / partner

so context matters.

23. ****lover of + thing/activity (愛好者) — 熱愛.....的人****

A separate common construction.

Practice 46

> “She is a ****lover of**** classical music.”

「她是古典音樂的****愛好者****。」

Practice 47

> “He has always been a ****lover of**** books.”

「他一直都是個**愛書之人**。」

lover of something = 非常喜歡某個活動、藝術、食物或事物的人

This does not imply romance.

24. **lovely = pleasant / beautiful / delightful (可愛 / 美好) — 可愛的；美好的；令人愉快的**

A related-looking word whose modern meaning has developed beyond simply “full of love.”

Practice 48

> “She has a **lovely** smile.”

「她有一個很**好看 / 可愛的笑容**。」

Practice 49

> “We had a **lovely** afternoon together.”

「我們一起度過了一個非常**愉快美好的下午**。」

lovely = 令人感到愉快、吸引、美好或可愛的

This is especially common in British English.

25. **lovely = kind / pleasant person (人) — 親切可愛的；很好的人**

Practice 50

> “Your grandmother sounds **lovely**.”

「你的外婆聽起來是個**很親切、很好的人**。」

Practice 51

> “Everyone says she is absolutely **lovely**.”

「大家都說她是個**非常親切可愛的人**。」

lovely = 形容一個人的性格或待人方式令人喜歡、感到溫暖

26. **love letter — 情書**

A common compound.

Practice 52

> “He wrote her a **love letter**.”

「他寫了一封**情書**給她。」

Practice 53

> “She kept the old **love letters** in a box.”

「她把舊**情書**收藏在盒子裡。」

love letter = 向某人表達浪漫愛意的信件

27. **love story — 愛情故事**

Practice 54

> “The film is a moving **love story**.”

「這部電影是一個感人的**愛情故事**。」

Practice 55

> “Their relationship became a famous **love story**.”

「他們的感情後來成為一段著名的**愛情故事**。」

love story = 以浪漫愛情和感情關係為主要內容的故事

28. **love at first sight — 一見鍾情**

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 56

> “For him, it was **love at first sight**.”

「對他來說，那是**一見鍾情**。」

Practice 57

> “They joked that theirs was **love at first sight**.”

「他們笑說兩人是**一見鍾情**。」

love at first sight = 第一次見到某人時便立即產生強烈浪漫感情

29. **for the love of God / for love's sake** (感嘆 / 較固定) — 拜託；看在.....份上

A fixed expressive use, with register caution.

Practice 58

> “For the **love of God**, be careful!”

「**拜託 / 看在老天份上**，小心一點！」

Practice 59

> “Do it for **love's sake**, not for money.”

「為了**愛本身**去做，而不是為了錢。」

These are idiomatic and more register-sensitive than the core senses.

Important distinction: **love vs like**

This is essential.

like

= enjoy / have a positive feeling toward

> “I like this song.”

「我喜歡這首歌。」

love

= much stronger affection or enjoyment

> “I love this song.”

「我非常喜歡 / 超愛這首歌。」

For people:

> **love**

can indicate deep family, romantic, or emotional attachment.

So **love** is usually much stronger than **like**.

Important distinction: **love someone vs be in love with someone**

love someone

can describe:

- * family love
- * friendship
- * romantic love

> “I love my grandmother.”

be in love with someone

specifically suggests:

> romantic love.

So:

> “I love my grandmother.”

is completely natural.

But:

> “I am in love with my grandmother.”

would normally imply romantic love and therefore means something entirely different.

Important distinction: **love vs care**

love

describes the deep emotional bond or affection itself.

care

often emphasizes:

- * concern
- * attention
- * responsibility for someone's wellbeing

A person can:

> care for someone

without necessarily loving them,

while love often motivates caring behaviour.

Your passage connects the two:

> she **shows love** through acts of **care**.

Important distinction: **love vs affection**

affection

means warm feelings of fondness and care.

love

can be deeper, broader, and stronger.

> “She showed affection toward the child.”

= 她對孩子表現出親切愛護。

> “She loved the child deeply.”

= 她深愛那個孩子。

****Affection**** often sounds gentler and less intense.

Important distinction: **love vs kindness**

**love**

= the emotional attachment or deep care.

**kindness**

= behaviour characterized by generosity, consideration, and care.

You can show:

> kindness to a stranger

without loving them.

Your grandmother's small acts are ****kind actions****, but because they are repeatedly directed toward family, the speaker interprets them as expressions of ****love****.

Important distinction: **loving vs lovable**

**loving**

= gives/shows love

> “a loving grandmother”

= 一位很疼愛家人的外婆

**lovable**

= easy to love

> “a lovable character”

= 一個惹人喜愛的角色

So:

****loving = gives love****

****lovable = receives/inspires love****

Important distinction: **loving vs lovely**

**loving**

= caring and affectionate.

**lovely**

= pleasant, beautiful, delightful, or very nice.

> “She is a loving grandmother.”

= 她很疼愛家人。

> “She is a lovely grandmother.”

= 她是一位很親切、討人喜愛的外婆。

Similar tone, different meaning.

Important distinction: **beloved vs loved**

**loved**

simply means:

> receiving love.

**beloved**

is stronger and often more emotional, literary, or formal:

> deeply loved / cherished.

> “his beloved grandmother”

= 他摯愛的外婆

Important distinction: **lover vs loved one**

Very important.

lover

usually means:

> romantic or sexual partner

loved one

means:

> someone deeply loved, especially family or partner

So your grandmother is naturally:

> a loved one

but not normally:

> a lover.

Important distinction: **love — affection vs love — tennis**

These are completely separate lexical meanings.

love

> “She shows love through small actions.”

= 關愛

love — tennis

> “The score is thirty-love.”

= 三十比零

Same spelling, completely different concept.

Family-extension note

Following the reference curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the ****love**** family:

- * ****love someone**** = 愛 / 深愛某人
- * ****love — family/friend affection**** = 關愛 / 深厚感情
- * ****romantic love**** = 愛情
- * ****be in love with**** = 愛上 / 愛著某人
- * ****fall in love**** = 墮入愛河
- * ****love something/doing something**** = 非常喜歡 / 熱愛
- * ****would love to**** = 很想 / 非常樂意
- * ****love of something**** = 對.....的熱愛
- * ****love for someone/something**** = 對.....的深厚感情 / 熱愛
- * ****first love**** = 初戀 / 最早的熱愛
- * ****loved one**** = 親人 / 摯愛的人
- * ****show love**** = 表達關愛
- * ****self-love**** = 自愛
- * ****love — tennis**** = 零分
- * ****loving**** = 有愛心 / 充滿關愛的
- * ****lovingly**** = 充滿愛意地
- * ****lovable**** = 惹人喜愛的
- * ****beloved**** = 摯愛的 / 深受愛戴的
- * ****lover — romantic**** = 戀人 / 情人
- * ****lover of something**** =愛好者
- * ****lovely**** = 美好、可愛、令人愉快的
- * ****love letter**** = 情書
- * ****love story**** = 愛情故事
- * ****love at first sight**** = 一見鍾情

As in the reference examples, this family contains genuine lexical meanings, grammatical constructions, common compounds, fixed expressions, and useful related forms. These should be included for learning value while keeping family extensions separate from senses of bare ****love****.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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love someone	對某人有深厚感情、關心和情感連繫	
love — family/friend affection	家人或親近的人之間深厚的關愛、依附和在乎	
romantic love	兩人之間帶有浪漫、親密意味的深厚感情	
be in love with	對某人有強烈浪漫愛情	
fall in love	開始對某人產生浪漫愛情	
love something/doing something	非常喜歡並享受某件事或活動	
would love to	非常想做某事，或很樂意接受邀請	
love of/for something	對某個人、領域或活動持久而強烈的熱愛	
love — loved person	被某人深深愛著的人，尤其常帶浪漫意味	
first love	最早產生深厚感情的人或最早真正熱愛的事物	
loved one	自己深愛和非常在乎的人，通常指家人或伴侶	
show love	透過照顧、支持、陪伴、言語或行動表達深厚關心	
self-love	對自己的價值、需要和身心保持尊重與關愛	
love — tennis	網球計分中的零分	
loving	經常表現出愛、關懷、溫柔和照顧的	
lovingly	以充滿愛、溫柔和關懷的方式	
lovable	性格或特質容易令人產生喜愛和感情的	
beloved	被深深愛著、珍惜或廣受愛戴的	
lover — romantic	與某人有浪漫或性關係的人	
lover of something	非常熱愛某個活動、藝術或事物的人	
lovely	令人感到愉快、美好、吸引或親切的	
love letter	向某人表達浪漫愛意的信件	
love story	以浪漫愛情和感情關係為主要內容的故事	
love at first sight	第一次見面便立即產生強烈浪漫感情	

For your original sentence

> “She is the kind of person who shows **love** through small actions rather than big speeches.”

The exact meaning is:

****love = 對家人深厚的關愛、在乎和情感連繫****

More specifically:

> ****show love through small actions****

= ****「透過細微而實際的照顧行為，表達對家人的愛和關心」****

In your passage, those actions include:

> making tea

> cutting fruit

> continuing to look after everyone even when the family tells her to rest

So ****love**** here is not romantic love. It is ****family affection expressed through practical care****.

That distinction is central:

> ****romantic love****

> = 愛情

while:

> ****family love / showing love through care****

> = 親情中的愛、關愛與照顧

And the sentence's deeper point is that her love is shown ****behaviourally rather than verbally****: she expresses affection by ****doing things for people****, not through “big speeches.”